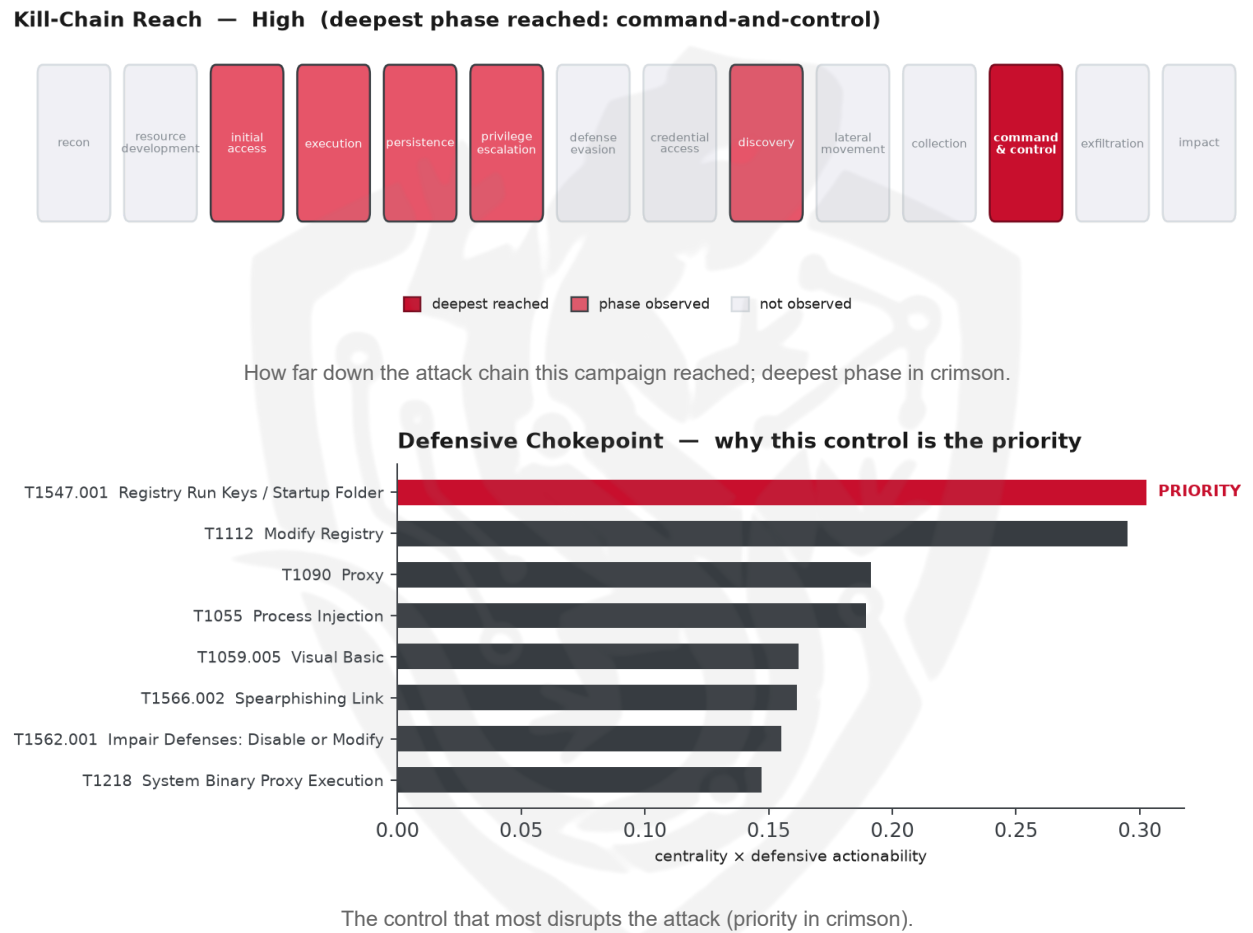


THREAT REPORT: UNKNOWN_ADVERSARY CAMPAIGN

Visual Summary



Summary

The observed cluster of activity has been identified as utilizing the Havoc, Banana RAT, and KongTuke malware families to target entities in Brazil. The threat actor's tactics involve exploiting various techniques to gain control over the victim's system. Priority should be given to auditing Windows Startup folders and Run/RunOnce registry keys for unauthorized entries. The actor's ability to hide behind Microsoft Defender DLP poses a significant threat, requiring immediate attention to defensive measures.

Threat Overview

The threat actor, whose identity is currently unknown, is employing a range of malware families, including Havoc, Banana RAT, and KongTuke, to compromise systems. The victimology indicates that entities in Brazil are being targeted, although specific sectors are not identified due to insufficient data. The absence

of a central CVE suggests that the actor may be leveraging various vulnerabilities or exploiting existing system weaknesses.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The attack chain involves a complex series of techniques, including system checks, spearphishing links, and process injection, ultimately leading to the establishment of persistence and control. The priority technique identified is T1547.001 Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder, which serves as a critical chokepoint in the attack chain. To mitigate this threat, the recommended priority control is to "Audit Windows Startup folders and Run/RunOnce registry keys for unauthorized entries; alert on .lnk or script creation in Startup by browser/email temp paths."

Infrastructure and Corroboration

Although specific hosting providers or ASNs are not identified, the malware families utilized by the threat actor, including Havoc and KongTuke, have been corroborated by abuse.ch. However, no indicators have been flagged with a confidence level of 80% or higher by AbuseIPDB, with the highest confidence seen being 0%. These corroboration efforts provide additional context to the threat, but do not override the primary source pulse.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1036.005 Match Legitimate Resource Name or Location
- T1497.001 System Checks
- T1566.002 Spearphishing Link
- T1218.007 Msiexec
- T1140 Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information
- T1055 Process Injection
- T1218 System Binary Proxy Execution
- T1112 Modify Registry
- T1090 Proxy
- T1547.001 Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder
- T1562.001 Impair Defenses: Disable or Modify Tools
- T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information
- T1036.001 Invalid Code Signature
- T1071.001 Web Protocols
- T1059.005 Visual Basic
- T1574.002 Hijack Execution Flow
- T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer
- T1037.001 Logon Script (Windows)

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1547.001 Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder (centrality 0.3187).
- Operational risk: High (score 0.636, reaches command-and-control).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.5; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
Windshift	0.5
WIRTE	0.4725
Molerats	0.4491
Sidewinder	0.441
LazyScripter	0.4099

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 0%.
- Malware families corroborated by abuse.ch: Havoc, KongTuke.
- Note: enrichment raises the severity signal (an IOC at or above 80% AbuseIPDB confidence, or a confirmed malware-family hit). This is context, not a change to the source assessment.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator	Context
Domain	thomphon[.]com	KongTuke · malware_download
Domain	e4wxbrg5277[.]com	

Type	Indicator	Context
Domain	49xb5hoiqsr[.]com	KongTuke
Domain	jh038x18gy9[.]com	
Hash	fb3630822b70bacb56aa4cec29b5a0e3e9acb3920809e70310a4003385a6d34a	Havoc
Hash	0743154262c5ccf24794168ee331feefc6539386715307ee44d5d9b6b321077	KongTuke
Hash	d24216d0b82747e9406a696da76960183926145f9621947e34a772137f5e22a6	Havoc
Hash	f2357e70f359803d42298d016c7e1631e9fba6c7e01e5df1eb8fb9ff7eb3df4e	Havoc
Hash	3578e1588846a805ee806fa6151b5801d0acb88879a93d378300e2ee7665736e	
Hash	7d4fb94f6b4623690daea67ed52e97705cb102f443988ff605f2a9c4898244dc	
Hash	eca5c297008e7c07a5c6fc9070c03121d702ef093b4a8e508b712040d87fed36	
Hash	1d09357b6a096fdc35cd5c873eed15665d6b3c879d20c8cf01e6bca0005512cf	
Hash	d2c637235d62ad766f961f9b8563f6a0e6db2ec0a343470385991b4df826afbc	
Hash	1fc515870c681bf3e1b7947e2248bbcf9918db2978117e91134de20bd42fd6a	
Hash	ced6b0f4441085bb9c54a32da9ab4ba14c6e21daf6e34fd61d54923f87baacd0	
Hash	afd5f1ed45a9867daf3bc64152cef460a06b164c8183e490db39146d4749a82c	
Hash	2cd88d5280a61714836f5f07a16df190911c5b952af2998dbbcda910b3b1c494	
Hash	00d979bdb1b29b2859f2120580f101f40e8e13de0b3b7bc29675e2c31098a03c	

Type	Indicator	Context
Hash	ae8cded2822c56dd85f52bba09d9285cb2db3e6317227530b848ea143afb067c	
Hash	9eefc66d1fca7f18a91f49affb569b41bcde043f91567e7f5cc9f2016aeddff8c	
Hash	c958de72460256c9c1cceef527d880862e8bc29e3ae4e2d478af97dcafd41180	
Hash	6dc41555455860b8584d761303a7ae5487117944e2a24d74fa3e91ad8f840077	
Hash	6b22df0de0a40ff372973639c8a1974cfb75084b8e3b85f9ab9038e0acce43c0	
Hash	31f27fdc14505e0cebe360579e1ba0326762cbe0948e50b5f920da51fdef1b51	
Hash	389a6a2007e4f06d16beac0ec2cb01391f80ad5e392343386cae3ceb82ec1502	
Hash	01b43dad62e56164771db696827a30ae	
Hash	07d0d4c580ac76ac3ffb63353c9b6b85	
Hash	19b2f2902825eaf62f2db1eb8aaa520a	
Hash	347a3f5f2ed2f503a22f68c4951c78c7	
Hash	37b996509ce2873f96781c9f9b12d8b5	
Hash	37e065585c573ecc082aacbfd31564eb	
Hash	4442897e3b772dfa4f7af109bec8924d	
Hash	609c3fc64a67630a7b206a6880c893a8	
Hash	63e45ffa6d0c22cb04646ef549d61065	
Hash	659575cb45a67b4d0c70e7361709fb03	
Hash	6b8ec32dc76fa3138f00616156962f4f	
Hash	6ee4050ac0c5192961c9f34568ca68fd	
Hash	7d384886720c8e576c3ca9d68cb5f08b	
Hash	9d066964414cff647beecb75affb5b5	

Type	Indicator	Context
Hash	a9198c1497481b2fea007ea5f13eafbf	

Reputation by AbuseIPDB · malware attribution by abuse.ch · Geo/ASN data by IP2Location LITE.

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1547.001 Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder (persistence)
- **Observed here:** the threat actor used T1112 Modify Registry here as an alternative persistence technique.
- **Projected pivot:** T1112 Modify Registry (persistence)
- **Basis:** observed in this campaign (an alternative the actor already demonstrated).

The actor could pivot to modifying registry keys directly using T1112 to maintain persistence or gain elevated privileges, potentially bypassing the blocked startup folder technique. This approach may allow the actor to achieve their objective by altering registry settings that enable malicious code execution or disable security features. To counter this, the defensive control of monitoring sensitive registry keys for modification and restricting registry-edit tools for unprivileged users should be implemented.

Detection and hardening for the pivot (T1112 Modify Registry)

- **Telemetry:** Sysmon (registry); EDR registry telemetry
- **Detect:**
 - Sysmon 12/13/14 (registry object add/set/rename) on sensitive keys
 - Writes to Run keys, service keys, security-provider and policy keys
 - reg.exe / regsvr32 spawned by office or script interpreters
- **Harden:**
 - Audit and restrict write access to security-sensitive registry hives
 - Application control to limit who can modify policy/security keys
- **MITRE:** M1047 Audit, M1024 Restrict Registry Permissions · DS0024 Windows Registry, DS0009 Process